

16. Be as independent as possible

Sometimes travel agents can come in handy. But with the amount of online resources these days, they're less valuable and more expensive. Check out the online communities and get familiar with Lonely Planet. Do a quick Google search for reviews on hotels and restaurants. There are loads of information to help you find affordable travel stops.

— Myscha Theriault

8 Great Ways to See the World for Free

Would you like to travel for free, even be paid a stipend, in exchange for contributing time to help a foreign community as a volunteer? Here are several options for free or very cheap travel through volunteering.

FREE LONG-TERM PROGRAMS

1. Peace Corps

The Peace Corps (www.PeaceCorps.gov) is the classic all-expenses-paid volunteer option that first comes to an American's mind. They offer two-year appointments, mostly in Africa, Asia, and South America, as well as modest stipends. Popular among recent college graduates, the Peace Corps is actually open to people of all ages.

2. United Nations

The United Nations (www.unv.org) volunteer program sends experienced professionals from almost any field to every region on earth. As a volunteer, all expenses, including airfares to and from your work site and any pre-appointment necessities like medical examinations and visas, are covered. In addition, volunteers receive various grants and stipends that vary in amount depending on the project's local economy. Like most of the groups in this list, they are looking for people with extensive experience in their field. Like the Peace Corps, most appointments are for 6 to 12 months, with renewable contracts.